

A proposed implementation approach for the Tri-Agency Data Deposit Requirement

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osf.io/vp7bf

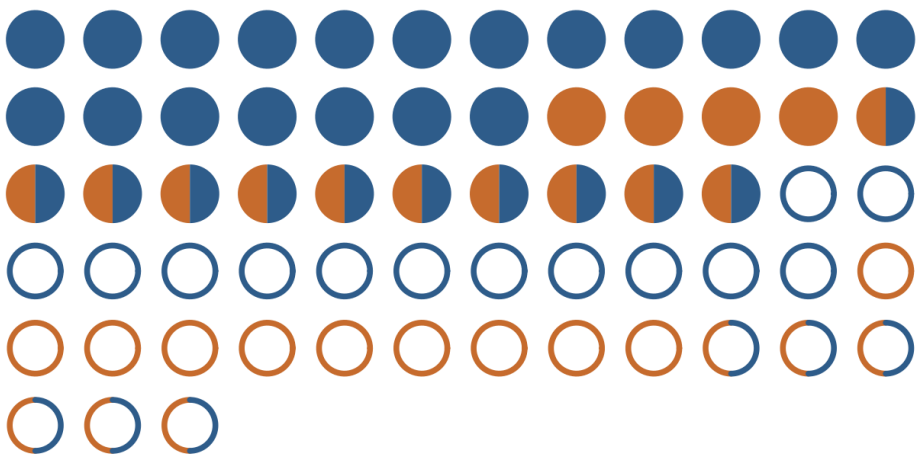
Tri-Agency Statement of Principles on Digital Data Management (2016)

- *As publicly funded organizations, the agencies are strong advocates for making the results of the research they fund as accessible as possible.*
- *The ability to store, access, reuse and build upon digital research data has become critical to the advancement of science and scholarship.*
- *The agencies believe that research data collected with the use of public funds belong, to the fullest extent possible, in the public domain and available for reuse by others.*

G20 and OECD funders

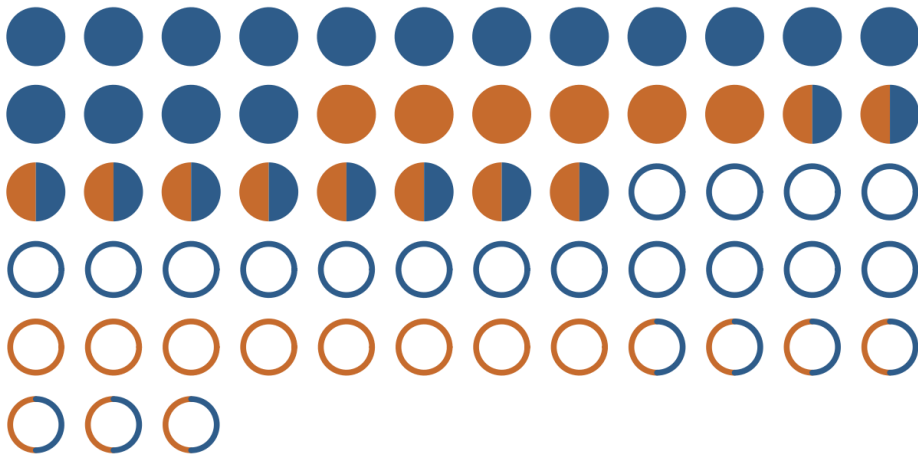


Data management plan



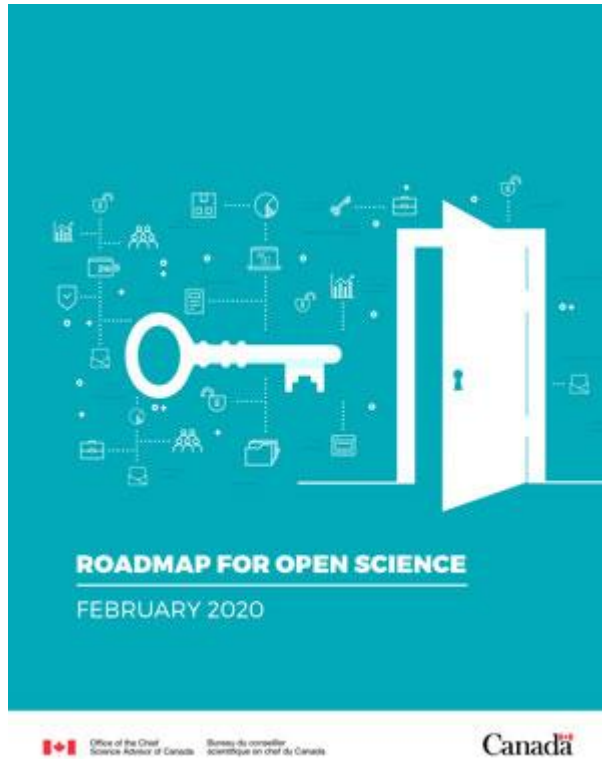
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Data deposit & sharing



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32 of 63

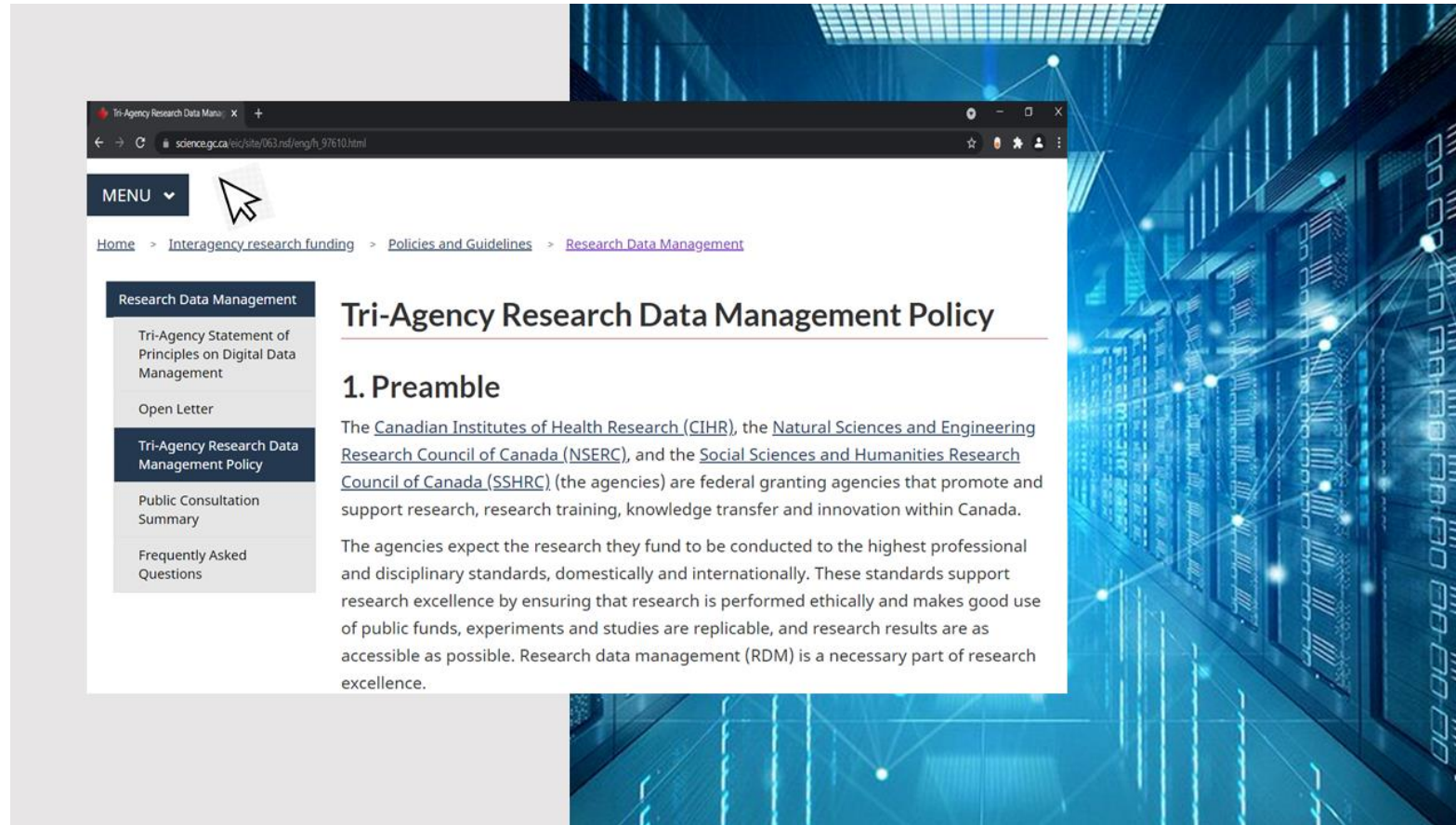
National context



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Tri-Agency RDM policy launched in March 2021



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Tri-Agency RDM Policy requirements



Institutional strategies

Each post-secondary institution and research hospital eligible to administer CIHR, NSERC or SSHRC funds is required to create an institutional RDM strategy, notify the agencies when it has been completed, and post it publicly.



Data Management Plans (DMPs)

For certain funding opportunities, the agencies will require DMPs to be submitted to the appropriate agency at time of application, as outlined in the call for proposals.



Data deposit

Grant recipients are required to deposit into a digital repository all digital research data, metadata and code that directly support the research conclusions in journal publications and pre-prints that arise from agency-supported research.

Tri-Agency RDM Policy – Indigenous research



Institutional strategies

Recognizing that data created in the context of research by and with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities, collectives and organizations will be managed according to principles developed and approved by those communities, communities and organizations, and in partnership with them; recognizing distinctions-based approaches.



Data Management Plans (DMPs)

For research conducted by and with First Nations, Métis and Inuit communities, collectives and organizations, DMPs must be co-developed with those communities, collectives and organizations, in accordance with RDM principles or DMP formats that they accept.



Data deposit

For research conducted by and with First Nations, Métis and Inuit communities, collectives and organizations, those communities, collectives or organizations will guide and ultimately determine how the data are collected, used and preserved. This could result in exceptions to the data deposit requirement.

Data Deposit – *What We Heard* Report



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What We Heard Report: Engagement on the data deposit requirement of the Tri-Agency Research Data Management Policy

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Mixed-methods study of 200+ RDM strategies

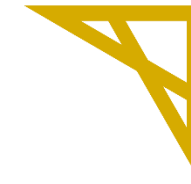


OPEN ACCESS | Research Article

Mapping Canadian institutional research data management strategies: a cross-sectional study

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Lucia Costanzo ^d, Dylanne Dearborn ^e, Aaron Franks^f, Sadia Khan^f, Elizabeth Lartey ^g, Kailyn Mackinnon ^a,
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Minglu Wang ^l, and Kelly D. Cobey ^{a,h}

[DOI: 10.1139/facets-2024-0332](https://doi.org/10.1139/facets-2024-0332)



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Clarifications to the data deposit requirement

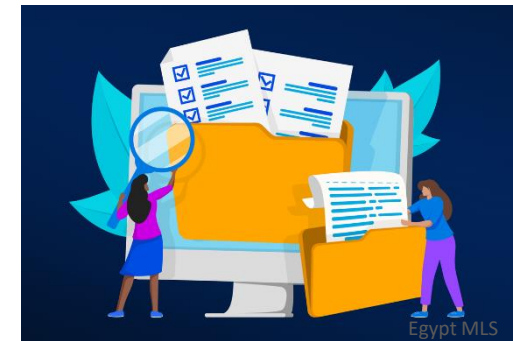
The agencies are proposing to clarify three aspects of the requirement:

- Data retention
- Data deposit
- Data availability

Retaining, depositing and sharing research data are fundamental to good research practice – they promote transparency, reproducibility, and reuse, strengthening research integrity and efficiency.

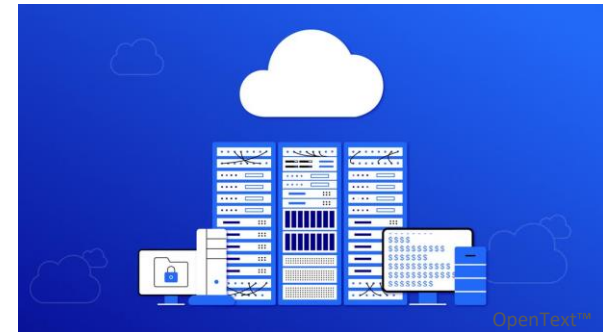
Data retention

- Requirement to **retain research data, data documentation, and code** arising from agency-supported research **for 10 years** post end of award or publication.
- Research data, data documentation, and code **must be adequately stored, backed-up and safeguarded** following the [Tri-Agency Framework: Responsible Conduct of Research](#) and [Tri-agency guidance on research security](#).
- For **research conducted by and with** Indigenous communities, their governance structures or relevant community representatives must determine if and how data are collected, used, retained, deposited, preserved, safeguarded and made available.



Data deposit

- Grant recipients are **required to deposit** into a digital repository all **research data and data documentation that directly support research findings in preprints and peer-reviewed articles** arising from agency-supported research.
- Data deposit must happen **by the time of publication** and the choice of repository should follow guidance on characteristics of trusted data repositories*.
- **Retention is acceptable for sensitive data and 'big data'** when no suitable repository exists.
- **Code** deposit is strongly encouraged.



Data availability

- ‘As open as possible, as closed as necessary.’
- Deposited data must be **openly accessible where ethical, cultural, legal and commercial requirements allow**, and in alignment with the FAIR principles and disciplinary standards.
- Preprints and peer-reviewed articles must include a **data availability statement** and a link to deposited data via a **persistent identifier (DOI)**.
- **Justification** for restricted data and info on access.
- **3 levels:** open, controlled-access, and closed data.



How to write a data availability statement: A brief guide

Created by:

Kevin Read, MLIS, MAS
Research Data Management & Open Science Librarian
University of Saskatchewan

Access request details	Provide instructions on what a person or party would be required to do to request access to your data. This should include the following, if applicable: • The contact information or direct link for where a request should be submitted to, • Application documents that should be submitted (e.g., a research proposal, study protocol, data management plan) including direct links, if available, and • Any costs associated with acquiring the data	"Access requests should be <i>sent to our institutional data access committee: email@email.com</i>. The request should include <i>a research proposal with a study protocol, an overview of how the survey data would be used, and a data management plan describing how the data will be securely and safely stored</i> over the course of the project, if access is granted. A data processing fee of \$500 will be applied if access is granted."
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[DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.18882097](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18882097)

Data availability: documentation

- Data documentation provides important information about a dataset so it can be understood and reused without contacting its creator.
- At a minimum, the README file must contain:
 - an explanation of variables, units of measurement, codes or abbreviations
 - any statistical transformations used
 - anonymization processes
 - a link to any relevant research output(s) (e.g. a preprint or journal article), as applicable.
- For qualitative data, the README file must also contain important details such as interview protocols, transcription conventions, and other contextual information that is essential to aid interpretation.

Data availability: embargoes

- Authors wanting to retain priority of access to their data can request an embargo on data availability from the journal where the article is published and/or the data repository where the data are deposited.
- The Agencies allow embargoes on data availability for up to three years; longer embargoes can be requested.
- An embargo on data availability is not an embargo on deposit; **the deposit requirement is maintained.**

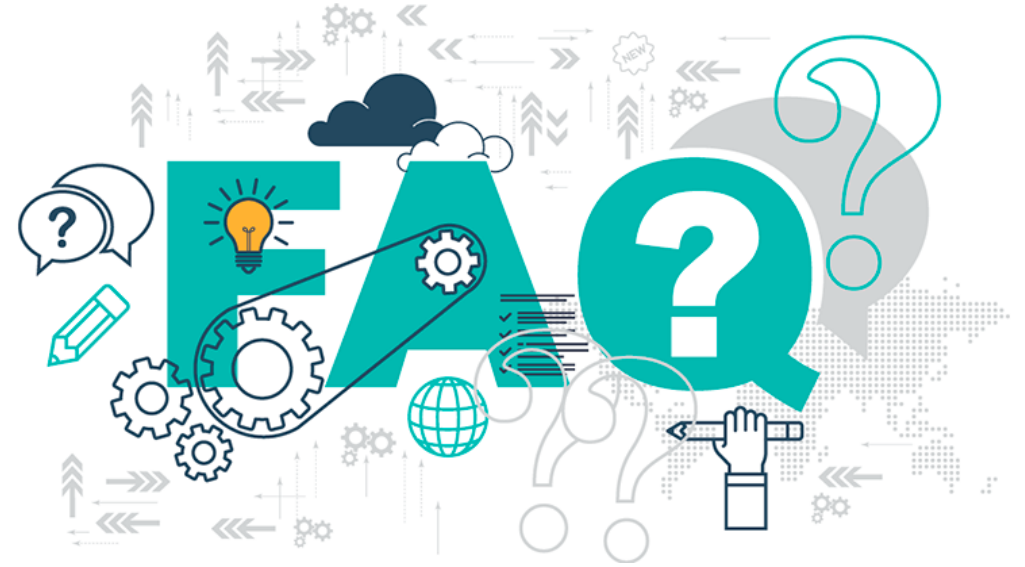


Q23. What are the agencies doing to value data as an important research contribution?

- As signatories to the [San Francisco Declaration on Research Assessment](#) (DORA), the agencies are committed to ensuring that a wide range of research outputs are considered and valued as part of the research assessment process (see [CIHR](#), [NSERC](#), and [SSHRC](#) guidance for merit review).
- [Guidelines for reviewing the tri-agency CV](#) also reflect this commitment to a more inclusive, diverse and holistic approach to excellence in research evaluation.
- Information on the implementation of DORA recommendations is available for each agency ([CIHR](#), [NSERC](#), [SSHRC](#)).

Policy enablers

- [FAQ](#) and **Glossary**
- [Guidance on data availability statements](#)
- **Guidance** on choosing a data repository
- [Guidance on broad consent](#) (SRCR)
- **Checklist** for researchers (CAM Initiative)
- **SSHRC Connection Grants:** [RDM CBI](#)



Anticipated timeline

- **Invitation for community feedback** on science.gc.ca until July 17, 2026 (8 weeks)
- **Announcement anticipated** for fall of 2026
- Requirement will apply to grants awarded on or after the **effective date** (anticipated 1 Jan 2027)



Merci - questions

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NSERC: ResearchData-Donneesderecherche@nserc-crsng.gc.ca

CIHR: ResearchData-Donneesderecherche@cihr-irsc.gc.ca

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